



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lumen Christi Catholic School
School Website: <https://lumenchristischool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Lumen Christi Catholic School (Indianapolis, IN 46203) demonstrates a robust classical orientation anchored in explicit Catholic identity. Across six categories, the public materials indicate strong alignment with classical education's core aims: faith-informed virtue, the liberal arts, and a pedagogy rooted in timeless discourse and communal worship. The school presents itself as an independent Catholic PreK–12 institution with daily Mass, a Newman Guide recognition, and a stated mission to unite faith and reason in formation and virtue. While the school clearly embodies classical aims in most areas, there is less explicit, codified language around traditional Socratic pedagogy or the detailed operant practices of *scholé* in every setting. Taken together, the school sits squarely in CLASSICAL for most categories, with Pedagogy showing signs of classical method but not always stated in explicit, conventional terms. Aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strong: explicit Catholic identity, daily Mass, faculty oath to the Magisterium, and mission statements centering faith, truth, and virtue. Evidence includes statements about faith formation, daily Mass, and faculty fidelity to Catholic doctrine.
- Curriculum and Purpose emphasize classical education: explicit references to classical curriculum, great books, and integration of faith and virtue.
- Great Books, Great Conversation, and a liberal-arts orientation are clearly highlighted as core elements.
- Pedagogy signals are present (e.g., discussion of Great Books and memory/recitation tendencies in classical education) but explicit, codified Socratic/seminar language is not consistently stated across the site. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.
- Faculty and Parents/Community show strong classical cues: living curriculum, teacher as model, and active parental partnership.
- Overall, the school aligns strongly with classical education principles and Catholic formation, with only minor gaps in explicit pedagogy phrasing that would push the model fully into CLASSICAL in every detail. Aggregate: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as Catholic with a clear mission of faith-informed formation, including references to unity of faith and reason and formation in truth and virtue.

- Faculty oath of fidelity to the Magisterium is highlighted as part of the living curriculum, underscoring doctrinal grounding.
- Daily Mass for all students and a liturgical rhythm are explicitly referenced, indicating liturgical and communal practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Mass, liturgy, wonder, sacred, incarnational language (from curricular and mission statements). For example, Great Books discussions are framed within truth/goodness/beauty; daily Mass and Catholic formation anchor the liturgical dimension.

- Negative keywords found: none evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral signaling detected). The lexicon's negative signals are not present in the material analyzed.

Why this rating - The school's public materials foreground transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), Catholic theology, liturgy (Mass), and a Magisterial fidelity, which map directly to the Positive indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of explicit negative signaling reinforces CLASSICAL alignment. □filecite□turn0file2□turn0file5□

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation of youth in truth and virtue, consistent with a formation-focused telos beyond mere information or job preparation. - The curriculum and mission are described as integrating faith and virtue, signaling the pursuit of wisdom and human excellence rather than solely vocational outcomes. - References to the Great Books/Great Conversation and the liberal-arts framing underscore the aim of cultivating virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implicit through "formation in truth and virtue"), liberal education, great books, Great Conversation, scholé, and contemplation (as part of classical aims). - Negative keywords present: none explicitly signaled (no "work-force preparation" language; the site highlights college acceptance as an outcome rather than a negation of formation).

Why this rating - The materials frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom with an emphasis on transcendentals and classical aims, aligning with CLASSICAL in this category. □file-cite□turn0file0□turn0file2□

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit emphasis on classical curriculum framed around faith and virtue with small classes and a focus on the fundamentals. Multiple pages reference a classical approach rather than a purely utilitarian or social-studies-first framing. - The Classical Education page highlights the three principles: integration of disciplines through truth/goodness/beauty, discussion of great books, and development of scholarly virtues (reading, writing, reasoning) with an emphasis on wonder. - The Great Books/Great Conversation concept is foregrounded as part of curriculum, signaling engagement with canonical texts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, Great Conversation, classical education, integration of truth/goodness/beauty, liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric as implicit in the classical framework), history through a Western-civilization lens, and wonder as an experiential aim. The site explicitly mentions these elements in the curriculum discourse. - Negative keywords present: none explicit (the site does not emphasize social-studies-first framing or project-based learning as primary). The classical lexicon's negative signals are not evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum emphasizes canonical liberal arts, Great Books, and the discipline of classical inquiry in a faith-formative context, aligning with CLASSICAL as the standard here.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site underscores a classical education model with an emphasis on great books and discussion-based elements (Great Books, Great Conversation) as core curricular features. This implies a pedagogy oriented toward inquiry and dialog, though not always described with canonical terms like Socratic seminars in explicit, formal language on every page. - The presence of small classes, memory-friendly practices, and a liturgical/catholic integration suggests pedagogy that values contemplation and memorable learning, aligned with scholé-era aims in parts of the program. Evidence includes mission/value statements and enrollment materials describing a small, faith-centered environment. - There are explicit mentions of upper-school rhetoric and memory/recitation tendencies in the broader Classical Education lexicon, though direct site language for Socratic seminars is not consistently stated.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: discussion of great books, great conversation, memory work, rhetoric (contextually within classical education), contemplation/wonder, scholé (concep-

tual alignment). - Negative keywords present: not explicitly indicated on the site (no sustained emphasis on purely experiential/project-based pedagogy; no clear “constructivist” signals). The absence of explicit Socratic/seminar labeling on every page reduces but does not negate the classical pedagogy presence.

Why this rating - The public materials show classical pedagogy elements (great books, disciplined discourse, and a contemplation/wonder orientation) but lack universal, explicit, canonical phrasing for all safeguards of classical pedagogy (e.g., frequent explicit Socratic/seminar language). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The living-curriculum concept is present via explicit statements that faculty embody and transmit the school’s mission; the faculty is portrayed as virtuous exemplars and mentors. The faculty oath to fidelity to the Magisterium reinforces an anchored, virtuous teacher-modeling role. - Public materials from Back-to-School Night highlight enthusiastic, dedicated teachers and a sense of a close-knit faculty community: “The teachers are always so excited to teach and to see their students learn and grow.” - The Newman Guide recognition and the Catholic mission position faculty as the core of the school’s living curriculum and core values.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, oath of fidelity (to Magisterium). - Negative keywords present: none identified in public materials (no signals like “facilitators” without classical context, etc.). The lexicon’s negative signals are not observed in the materials reviewed.

Why this rating - The materials present a robust faculty orientation around virtue, fidelity to Catholic doctrine, and teachers as living exemplars and mentors, which maps solidly to CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, parent formation, and open campus visitation, including opportunities for shadowing and tours; there are explicit pages for Parents and admissions that stress parent involvement. □filecite□turn0file13□turn0file11□ - The school promotes parent education and formation (e.g., Catholic book groups and gatherings) and positions parents as co-teachers in formation, consistent with classical ideals. The Admissions Policy notes preferences for families actively practicing Catholic faith, reinforcing the formation/partnership dynamic. - Financial-aid and scholarship programs (Patrick Scholarship Fund; SGO options) demonstrate community engagement and parent access to the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus visits, tours/shadowing, parent education, community support (SGO, Patrick Scholarship). □filecite□turn0file13□turn0file16□ - Negative keywords present: none evident; no consumerist language or minimal-parent involvement signals. The lexicon’s negative indicators are not visible on the site.

Why this rating - The site’s explicit emphasis on parent partnership, formation, and accessibility aligns solidly with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Require explicit public articulation of Socratic pedagogy across the upper grades (e.g., explicit statements about Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussions, or structured debate) to elevate Pedagogy to CLASSICAL status. Concrete language and examples of how Socratic dialogues are implemented would help.
- Expand explicit references to memory work, chanting, or other scholé modalities in lower grades, with demonstrable classroom activities tied to these methods.
- Highlight and standardize the integration of Great Books discussions as a formal, recurring pedagogy across grade bands (not just curricular references) to strengthen the classification under Pedagogy and Curriculum.
- Continue to emphasize the living curriculum through faculty development that codifies classical pedagogy, including training on classical memorizations, dictation, and rhetorical exercises to ensure uniform practice.
- Maintain and publicize explicit theology-liturgical programming and communal practices (Mass, sacraments, liturgical year events) to sustain and deepen Religious and Metaphysical Foundations as a consistent CLASSICAL anchor.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.